

any software can be done via simple text commands in the terminal or via the bundled software manager. No more hassles with spyware and malware as you would never need to get your parents to go to a web site to download any required software.

All the basic Windows software has a counterpart in linux. OpenOffice, all the browsers except IE (which can still be emulated via wine), VLC, Thunderbird, most of the bundled games, etc.

An indirect advantage of linux would also be that the pesky little neighbour's kids won't be able to come and mess about with the computer too much while you're away!

For the setup, just install Ubuntu on one large partition. Unity would be preferred as you can just add all the essential programs in the side-bar. Set up automatic updates and make sure that all the necessary codecs and browser plug-ins are installed. Install programs like Picasa to manage images, VLC for videos, etc.

## FACEBOOK

This social networking site needs no introduction. It's a site that's, almost literally, all pervasive and is as synonymous with the internet as Google.

### Enable timeline

Facebook had recently announced that they were going



Facebook timeline



### The facebook language options, don't hesitate to experiment

to release a new feature which they called a "Timeline". Unfortunately, the release date for this feature was pushed back. There is however, a way to enable this feature right now.

If you're a Facebook app developer and have a developer account, it's quite possible that you already have a timeline invite and are using it. If you don't, here is how you go about getting one.

You'll first need to enable developer mode. To do this, just log in to Facebook and go to <http://developers.facebook.com/apps>

Create a new app and rename it to whatever you like. Accept the Facebook Platform Policies and proceed.

You'll need a verified account to proceed beyond this step. Preferably use your mobile number for verification. If you're

worried about privacy, you can delete the number later.

Select "Open Graph" from the left side Select "Get Started". Create a "test action", you can just type in the default examples that are given. You can put say, People can "watch" a "movie" or



### The first steps to creating your very own Facebook app

anything else you feel like. Then click on Get Started. Your app should now be ready.

Wait a few minutes and refresh your Facebook homepage. You should now receive a developer invite to timeline.

### Change languages

Facebook gives you the option of changing your language. What is so great in that you ask? Well, you can try out some interesting ones like English (Pirate), "What be troublin' ye?", or even leet speak, "wh47 Occu!35 j00r 7h!nk!ngz?" A few extra like Dothraki or

Klingon would have been much appreciated.

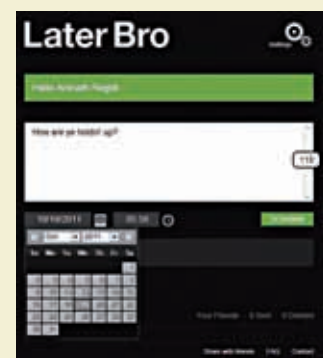
## Access deals

Facebook has introduced a feature called "Check-in deals". If you use a smartphone, you just login to the Facebook app and, if you check in and provide your location and what cafe or store you intend to visit, Facebook will notify you if there is a deal available at the place you're visiting. You can then just select "Check in" and you'll be able to redeem that deal. There are various types of deals, some that require your friends to be present and so on. An interesting feature to look at if you're in the habit of travelling a lot.

### Express yourself

Facebook restricts your status updates to 420 characters, if,

for whatever reason, you feel a bit more expressive, upload a photo as a status update and then you can type whatever you want underneath!



You can easily schedule status updates using LaterBro